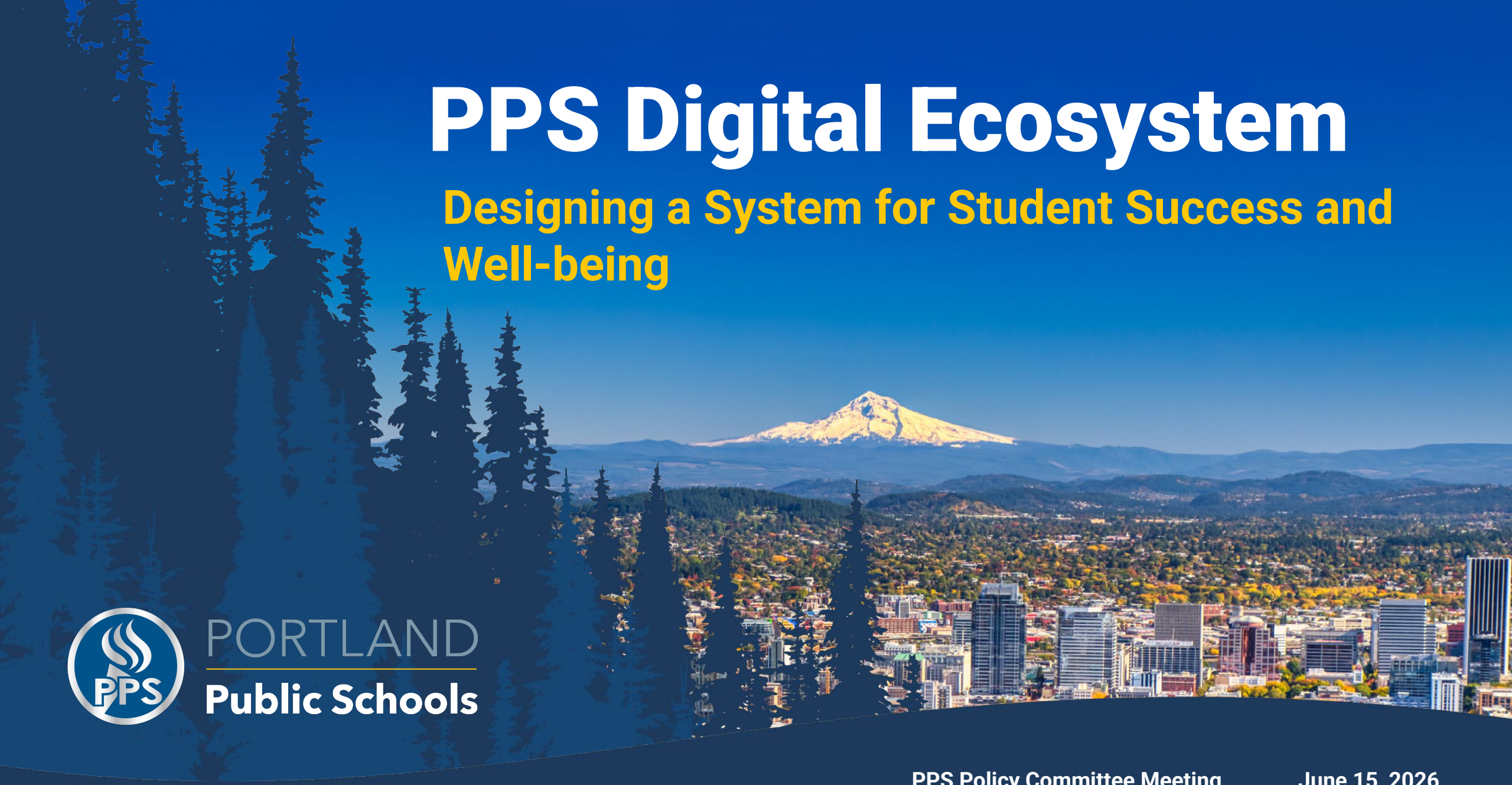
PPS Digital Ecosystem

Designing a System for Student Success and Well-being



PORTLAND
Public Schools

PPS Policy Committee Meeting

June 15, 2026

Learning Target + Success Criteria

I am learning about the PPS digital ecosystem pillars and system recommendations for technology integration and use in schools.
I can identify the PPS five digital ecosystem pillars: Screen Time, Digital Literacy, Educational Tools, Online Safety, and Research.

PPS Digital Ecosystem

PORTLAND Public Schools

Defining the Digital Ecosystem Pillars



Screen Time

Balanced digital engagement for student health.



Digital Literacy

Navigating information and media responsibly.



Educational Tools

Curriculum, apps, and software



Online Safety: Filtering + Monitoring

Systems for filtering and monitoring content.



What the Research Says

Current studies on active digital engagement.

Screen Time

PORTLAND Public Schools

Digital Ecosystem Pillars



Screen Time

Balanced digital engagement for student health.

Active vs. Passive

Modern research emphasizes Active Engagement (creating, coding, problem-solving) over Passive Consumption (scrolling, binge-watching). Quality of interaction is a far better predictor of well-being than raw duration alone.

Context & Co-Viewing

Digital engagement skyrockets in quality when combined with caregiver or peer interaction (Joint Media Engagement). Policy focuses on swaps over cuts—shifting from passive to intentional, thinking-first usage.

American Academy of Pediatrics

"...we recommend considering the quality of interactions with digital media and not just the quantity, or amount of time."

"...there is evidence that rules focusing on balance, content, co-viewing and communication are associated with better well-being outcomes than rules focused on screen time."

Digital Literacy

PORTLAND Public Schools

Digital Ecosystem Pillars



Digital Literacy

Navigating information and media responsibly.

Standards Aligned:	**Integration of AI Literacy into Media Literacy:**	**Cross-departmental Collaboration:**	**Ethical Citizenship:**
Alignment with Graduate Portrait and the The International Society for Technology in Education (ISTE) Standards*.	Learning to critique social inequities in digital spaces.	(OTIS, Health, MTSS, CTE, Library Services, Professional Learning, Academics).	Developing skills required for an interconnected world.

**The ISTE Standards are a framework that guides educators in using technology to create high-impact, sustainable and scalable learning experiences for all students.*

Educational Tools

PORTLAND Public Schools

Digital Ecosystem Pillars



Educational Tools

Curriculum, apps, and software

We prioritize digital cognition over mere digital usage. Digital tools should extend student thinking, not replace it.

- Students remain architects of their own work.
- Technology supports high-quality, rigorous instruction.
- Critical analysis of digital media (media literacy).

Core Curriculum

- Paper-based and text-based resources with digital components

Assistive and Augmentative Tools

- Extended Practice
- Assessment and Intervention

Artificial Intelligence

Online Safety: Filtering & Monitoring

PORTLAND Public Schools

Digital Ecosystem Pillars



Online Safety: Filtering + Monitoring

Systems for filtering and monitoring content to keep students safe.

Device Level Security
Industry-standard filtering on all PPS laptops and staff phones to block age-inappropriate content.

Network Operations
Proactive monitoring of device usage via the Security Operations Team.

Responsible Use Policy
Evolving policies to match the rapid pace of evolving tech needs, including AI.

Academics Partnership
Collaborative monitoring to ensure safety doesn't disrupt instructional flow.

Questions, Comments, Next Steps